

With 5.9 million Ukrainian refugees recorded globally and 4.3 million under EU temporary protection, the URC 2026 conference spotlighted diaspora engagement and voluntary return as central to Ukraine's \$588B recovery agenda. IOM and Ukrainian government held dedicated side events on reactivating diaspora talent. Retention and return infrastructure remain critically underfunded relative to humanitarian needs.

URC 2026 marks a strategic pivot: Ukraine is formally institutionalizing diaspora reactivation and voluntary return programs as reconstruction pillars, signaling that human capital recovery is now co-equal with physical infrastructure rebuilding.

RETURN

Diaspora Engagement Side Event at URC 2026

Ukraine's Ministry of Social Policy hosted a dedicated side event at URC 2026 on cooperation with Ukrainians abroad, focusing on facilitating voluntary return and diaspora engagement mechanisms as part of the national recovery framework.

3R: Direct policy action on Return pillar: government formalizing diaspora reactivation channels and voluntary return facilitation at highest-level recovery conference.

IOM Migration Trends Data Presented at URC 2026

IOM Europe and Central Asia presented latest migration trend data at URC 2026, providing evidence base for diaspora reactivation strategies and informing policymakers on movement patterns of displaced Ukrainians across the region.

3R: Data infrastructure for Return pillar: IOM evidence enables targeted diaspora outreach and return corridor design based on actual migration patterns.

IOM EUROPE FACEBOOK

5.9 Million Refugees Recorded; Return Conditions Still Fragile

Instagram data from IOM confirms 5.9 million Ukrainian refugees globally, with 10.8 million needing humanitarian assistance. Families who have returned continue to face significant hardship, underlining that return must be paired with reconstruction support.

3R: Scale and fragility signal for Return pillar: high refugee numbers plus difficult post-return conditions demand robust reintegration support alongside return incentives.

IOM INSTAGRAM

RECRUIT

IOM Urges \$588B Recovery Investment in People at URC 2026

IOM urged greater investment in people and communities at URC 2026, contextualizing Ukraine's \$588B decade-long recovery need. The call emphasizes filling critical skill gaps in reconstruction sectors through targeted human capital investment strategies.

3R: Core Recruit signal: massive reconstruction demand creates acute skilled labor shortages; IOM positioning human capital investment as prerequisite for recovery success.

IOM UKRAINE

UNHCR Exhibition: Refugee Skills and Belonging in Ukraine

UNHCR's new exhibition highlights Ukraine as both refugee-hosting and refugee-sending country, spotlighting stories of displaced persons with transferable skills. This dual narrative opens recruitment pathways for refugee talent integration into Ukraine's labor market.

3R: Adjacent Recruit opportunity: refugees hosted in Ukraine possess skills relevant to reconstruction; UNHCR narrative supports their formal labor market integration.

UNHCR UKRAINE

RETAIN

4.3 Million Ukrainians Under EU Temporary Protection — Retention Risk

Council of Europe Commissioner reports 4.3 million displaced Ukrainians under EU temporary protection as of March 2026, calling for continued solidarity. Extended protection status

increases risk of permanent settlement abroad, deepening brain drain if return conditions remain poor.

3R: Critical Retain warning: prolonged EU temporary protection normalizes diaspora life, reducing return probability and accelerating permanent human capital loss for Ukraine.

COUNCIL OF EUROPE

5.7 Million Ukrainians Abroad — Scale of Brain Drain Threat

UNHCR data confirms over 5.7 million Ukrainian civilians abroad due to war. This scale of displacement, concentrated among working-age and educated populations, represents an existential human capital threat requiring urgent retention and return policy responses.

3R: Foundational Retain data point: 5.7M figure anchors the urgency of anti-brain-drain policies; working-age concentration makes this a structural economic emergency.

VISIT UKRAINE / UNHCR

UNHCR Romania: Protection Training Signals Long-Term Displacement

UNHCR Romania delivered training sessions on forced displacement and international protection in June 2026, institutionalizing long-term refugee support infrastructure. This signals Romania is preparing for extended Ukrainian displacement, reducing urgency of return for refugees there.

3R: Retain risk indicator: host country institutionalization of refugee support reduces pull-back pressure on Ukrainians to return, exacerbating human capital outflow.

UNHCR / RELIEFWEB

GLOBAL CONTEXT

IOM: 82.2 Million Internally Displaced Worldwide by End 2025

IOM's global report confirms 82.2 million IDPs worldwide by end 2025, with IOM reaching 17.8 million people amid record displacement. Ukraine's crisis sits within a global displacement surge, competing for international attention and funding resources.

3R: Global context for all 3R pillars: Ukraine competes in a record-displacement environment for donor funding, policy attention, and skilled diaspora engagement resources.

IOM GLOBAL

Mozambique Displacement Alert — Unrelated to Ukraine

IOM DTM report on Mozambique NSAG-driven displacement in Ancuabe District (May–June 2026) is unrelated to Ukraine but illustrates IOM's global displacement monitoring capacity that also supports Ukraine-specific data collection and analysis frameworks.

3R: Peripheral relevance only: confirms IOM DTM infrastructure globally, which underpins Ukraine displacement monitoring — no direct 3R signal for Ukraine human capital.

IOM DTM
